

CODEALPHA CYBERSECURITY INTERNSHIP

Phishing Awareness Training

Learn how cybercriminals manipulate users through phishing emails, fake websites, and social engineering attacks — and discover practical ways to stay protected online.

Training Guide

What is Phishing?

Phishing is a cyberattack where criminals impersonate trusted organizations or individuals to steal sensitive information such as passwords, banking credentials, or personal data.

Email Phishing

Fraudulent emails pretending to be from banks, companies, or trusted services.

Spear Phishing

Targeted phishing attacks aimed at specific individuals or organizations.

Smishing & Vishing

Phishing through SMS messages or phone calls designed to steal information.

Social Engineering Tactics

Attackers often exploit human psychology rather than technology vulnerabilities.

Authority

Attackers pretend to be managers, banks, or IT departments.

Urgency

Messages create panic to force quick reactions without thinking.

Fear & Curiosity

Scammers use fear or exciting offers to manipulate victims.

How to Spot Phishing Emails

Suspicious Sender

Emails from unknown or slightly altered domains.

Urgent Messages

"Your account will be suspended immediately!"

Malicious Attachments

Unexpected files asking you to download or enable macros.

Fake Links

Links redirecting users to fraudulent websites.

Recognizing Fake Websites

Misspelled URLs

Example: g00gle.com
instead of google.com

No HTTPS

A missing padlock icon
may indicate an unsafe
site.

Poor Website Design

Broken layouts,
grammar mistakes,
and suspicious
popups.

Phishing Attack Flow

Understanding how a phishing attack works can help you stop it before damage occurs.



Real-World Phishing Examples

Bank Scam

Fake bank emails asking users to verify accounts through malicious links.

Delivery Scam

Messages claiming a package delivery problem with fake tracking links.

Workplace Scam

Emails impersonating HR or company executives requesting urgent payments.

Knowledge Check

Question 1

Which is a major phishing warning sign?

- A. Friendly greeting
- B. Urgent request for password
- C. Secure HTTPS website

Correct Answer: B

Question 2

What should you do before clicking a link?

- A. Click quickly
- B. Hover to inspect URL
- C. Ignore browser warnings

Correct Answer: B

Best Practices to Stay Safe

- **Enable MFA:** Add an extra security layer using Multi-Factor Authentication.
- **Verify Requests:** Confirm suspicious messages through official channels.
- **Think Before Clicking:** Avoid rushing when reading emails or messages.
- **Use Strong Passwords:** Create unique passwords for every account.
- **Keep Systems Updated:** Install software updates and security patches regularly.
- **Report Suspicious Emails:** Notify your IT or security department immediately.

Completed for CodeAlpha Task 2 — Phishing Awareness Training